

Microneedling Depth by Indication

Needle depth, device settings, treatment intervals, and post-care by indication

MICRONEEDLING DEPTH REFERENCE BY INDICATION				
Indication	Needle Depth	Passes	Sessions Needed	Interval
Fine lines (superficial)	0.25–0.5mm	2–3	4–6	3–4 weeks
Texture / enlarged pores	0.5–1.0mm	3–4	4–6	3–4 weeks
Mild acne scarring	1.0–1.5mm	3–4	6–8	4–6 weeks
Moderate acne scarring	1.5–2.0mm	4–5	6–10	4–6 weeks
Severe / ice pick scarring	2.0–2.5mm	4–6	8–12+	6–8 weeks
Stretch marks	1.5–2.5mm	4–6	6–10	6–8 weeks
Hyperpigmentation / melasma	0.25–0.5mm (superficial only)	2–3	4–6	3–4 weeks
Skin laxity / tightening	1.0–1.5mm	3–4	4–6	4–6 weeks
Hair loss (scalp)	0.5–1.5mm	3–4 (scalp)	6–12	2–4 weeks
Surgical scars (mature)	1.0–2.0mm	4–5	6–10	4–6 weeks

RF MICRONEEDLING – ENERGY SETTINGS BY ZONE			
Device Zone	Depth	Energy Level	Notes
Forehead	0.5–1.5mm	30–50%	Avoid too deep over frontal bone. Thin skin. Lower energy.
Periorbital (crow's feet)	0.5–1.0mm	20–40%	Very thin skin. Conservative depth and energy. Avoid orbital rim.
Cheeks	1.0–2.0mm	40–70%	Thicker skin with more fat. Tolerates deeper treatment.
Nose	0.5–1.0mm	20–30%	Thin skin over cartilage. Conservative always.
Perioral	0.5–1.5mm	30–50%	Caution near lip border. Dynamic area.
Chin/jawline	1.0–2.0mm	40–60%	Good for skin tightening. Bony landmarks — stay above periosteum.
Neck	0.5–1.0mm	20–30%	Thin skin. Very conservative. No more than 0.5–1mm. Lower energy always.
Décolletage	0.5–1.0mm	20–30%	Thin and sun-damaged. Start conservative. Slow to heal.
Body (abdomen, thighs)	1.5–2.5mm	50–70%	Thicker skin tolerates deeper treatment. Good for stretch marks.

POST-MICRONEEDLING PROTOCOL

Hours 0–24	Apply only provider-recommended products (hyaluronic acid serum, growth factor). No active ingredients. No makeup. Gentle cleanser only.
Hours 24–72	Skin will appear red, feel warm, may be mildly swollen. Normal. Continue gentle skincare. Apply SPF 50+ when going outside.
Days 3–5	Peeling and flaking begins. Do not pick or peel. Hyaluronic acid + moisturizer. Some patients have no visible peeling — also normal.
Days 7–14	Skin normalizes. May reintroduce retinoid and active ingredients gradually. SPF 50+ daily for minimum 2 weeks post-treatment.
Avoid	Sun exposure, saunas, hot showers, exercise (48–72 hrs), swimming, makeup (24 hrs), active ingredients (5–7 days depending on depth)
GHK-Cu / growth factors	Apply immediately post-treatment — micro-channels enhance penetration dramatically. Excellent for boosting collagen stimulation results.

MICRONEEDLING + COMBINATION TREATMENTS

- ✓ GHK-Cu copper peptide: apply immediately post-needling — channels dramatically improve delivery. Enhances collagen stimulation.
- ✓ PRP (platelet-rich plasma): apply to skin during needling or post-procedure. Significantly accelerates healing and results.
- ✓ Vitamin C serum: apply post-needling (L-ascorbic acid delivers deeper via channels). Enhanced brightening and collagen support.
- ⚠ Retinoids: do NOT apply post-needling — too irritating on compromised skin. Resume after full healing (7–14 days).
- ⚠ AHAs/BHAs: do NOT apply post-needling for same reason. Channels make penetration unpredictable and excessive.

CONTRAINDICATIONS – MICRONEEDLING

ABSOLUTE CONTRAINDICATIONS

Active acne breakout in treatment area

Active skin infection (bacterial, viral, fungal)

Accutane within 6–12 months

Active rosacea flare in treatment area

Keloid or hypertrophic scar history

Blood coagulation disorders

Pacemaker or implanted metal near area (RF devices)

Pregnancy

RELATIVE CONTRAINDICATIONS (PROCEED WITH CAUTION)

Diabetes — impaired healing, higher infection risk

History of HSV — pre-treat with antivirals

Immunosuppression — slower healing

Recent sunburn in treatment area

Eczema, psoriasis in treatment area

On blood thinners — increased bruising

Very dark Fitzpatrick (V–VI) — PIH risk. Conservative settings mandatory

Wound healing disorders